George Carlin's Guide to Dining Out

By George Carlin

NARRATOR: Are you a fan of restaurant chains? I'm not. Every now and then I get a Waffle House attack, and I have to get something scattered and smothered, but I don't make a habit of it. After all, Applebee's slogan of Eatin' Good in the Neighborhood takes on a whole new meaning when you think about the fact that they have 2,000 locations. Then of course there is Olive Garden whose food is about as Italian as Taco Bell is Mexican. And last but not least, there is my beloved IHOP, where you can be convinced that pancakes with dripping strawberry syrup and whipped cream is a healthy dinner any day of the week!

(Excerpted from Restaurant Menus Recreated to be Honest by Diana Adams https://bitrebels.com/entertainment/restaurant-menus-recreated-to-be-honest-humor/)

INTRODUCTION

Let's face it. The American public is in LOVE with eating out. Some studies have shown the average American eats out 4 to 5 times a week. How many other "pleasurable" activities does the average adult engage in 4 to 5 times a week?

Food is IMPORTANT but enjoying yourself during the dining experience is also important. In the true nature of fun, I offer you George Carlin's Guide to Dining Out (may he rest in peace)

NARRATOR: **(Pg 8-13)** There are certain clues that tell you how much a restaurant will cost. If the word ***cuisine*** appears in the advertising, it will be expensive. If they use the word ***food***, it will be moderately priced. However, if the sign says ***eats***, even though you'll save some money on food, your medical bills may be quite high.

I don't like trendy food. When I hear, "sauteed boneless panda groin," I know I'm in the wrong place. There's such a thing as pretentious food. Puree of woodchuck, marinated bat nipples, weasel chops, porcupine cacciatore. Or fried eagle. A guy said to me recently,

GUY: C'mon, we'll go to Baxter's, they have really great fried eagle."

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NARRATOR: I'm thinkin' to myself, "Do I really wanna know this guy?" However, if you are going to dine with pretentious people, here are some items you can order that are sure to impress *(each said with a different affectation)*:

- gorilla fondue,
- filet of hyena,
- jackal tartare,
- rack of prairie dog,
- free-range mole en brochette,
- wolf noodle soup,
- loin of chipmunk,
- koala flambe, and
- wombat souvlaki

Then, at the other end of the spectrum, there is the decidedly non-trendy restaurant, where the special sometimes is simply "meat." Big sign in the window: **"Today's special: Meat."**

CUSTOMER: I'll have the meat.

WORKER: Would you like sauce with that?

CUSTOMER: What kind of sauce would that be?

WORKER: That would be meat sauce.

NARRATOR: It's similar to a fish sandwich. Have you ever seen these places that feature "fish sandwiches"? I always think, "Well, that's kind of general." I mean, I wouldn't order something called a "meat sandwich," would you?" At least not without a couple of follow-up questions:

CUSTOMER: Does anyone know where this meat came from? . . . Are any of the waitresses missing?

NARRATOR: I think when you eat out you should have a little fun; it's good for digestion. Simple things. After the waiter recites a long list of specials, ask him if they serve cow feet. But act really interested in the specials. When he says,

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WAITER: Today we have goat-cheese terrine with arugula juice, sauteed cod with capers and baby vegetables, coastal shrimp cooked in spiced carrot juice, roast free-range chicken with ginger and chickpea fries, and duck breast in truffle juice.

NARRATOR: Act like you're completely involved. Say,

CUSTOMER: The cod. What is the cod sauteed in?

WAITER: A blend of canola and tomato oils.

CUSTOMER: *(No hurry here.)* Ahhh, yes! *(pointing thoughtfully at the waiter)* I'll have the grilled cheese sandwich.

NARRATOR: Even some low-end places are pretentious. The menu can't merely say "cheeseburger." They have to get wordy. So, go along with them. When you order your food use their language. But you must look right at the waiter; no fair reading from the menu. Look him in the eye and say . . .

CUSTOMER: I'll have the succulent, fresh-ground, government-inspected, choice, all-beef, six-ounce patty on your own award-winning sesame-seed bun, topped with a generous slice of Wisconsin's finest Grade-A cheddar cheese made from only premium milk and poured from large, galvanized steel cans, having originally been extracted from a big, fat, smelly, champion blue-ribbon cow with a brain disease.

NARRATOR: Continue that style with other items: Instead of asking for a glass of water, say you'd like a . . .

CUSTOMER: cylindrical, machine-blown, clear drinking vessel filled with nature's own colorless, odorless, extra-wet, liquid water.

NARRATOR: Have fun. Be difficult. Order unusual things: a chopped corn sandwich. Rye potato chips. Filet of bone with diced peas. Peanut butter and jellyfish. Ask for a glass of skim water. Insist on fried milk. Chocolate orange juice. Order a grilled gorgonzola cheese sandwich on whole-wheat ladyfingers. Then top the whole thing off with a bowl of food coloring and a large glass of saturated fat.

Issue special instructions. Ask for the French toast, medium rare. Get a pizza with no toppings, hold the crust. Tell 'em you want eggs: "Fry the whites and poach the yolks."

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Order a basket of poppy seed rolls and tell them to scrape off the seeds and put them in a separate bowl and heat them to 200 degrees. Keep them busy.

Tell your waiter you want to make a substitution: "Instead of my napkin, I'll have the lobster tails." See what he says. Ask him if the garnish is free. If it is, tell him all you're having is a large plate of garnish.

If they have a salad bar, ask how many times you can go back. If they say as many times as you like, ask for a lawn bag. Come back the next day with a small truck. Tell them you weren't quite finished eating the night before. You're actually within your legal rights, because, technically, no one is ever finished eating.

Ask him if the chef would mind preparing a dish that's not on the menu. Then describe something simple but unusual. Like half a coconut filled with egg whites. When the waiter comes back and says,

WAITER: Yes, the chef said he will be delighted to make that for you . . .

NARRATOR: Tell him, "Well, never mind, I don't like that anymore." When the food arrives, change your mind. Say. . .

CUSTOMER: I've changed my mind, waiter. Instead of the roast suckling pig, I believe I'll have a half order of Kellogg's Product 19.

NARRATOR: And always, when the food arrives, send something back. It's considered very sophisticated. But make sure you use colorful language. Tell him . . .

CUSTOMER: Waiter, this veal tastes like the inside front panel of Ferdinand Magellan's shorts. And I'm referring to the first voyage.

NARRATOR: Show him you're a man of new ideas. When he comes with the pepper mill . . . Actually, the pepper mill can be a source of ***great*** fun. Keep the waiter going on the pepper mill for a long time. Disturbingly long. Until everyone in the restaurant is really uncomfortable. Then, when your food and silverware are completely covered with a thin layer of ground pepper, say . . .

CUSTOMER: Okay, stop! That's perfect!

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NARRATOR: Then, a few minutes later, call the waiter over and tell him . . .

CUSTOMER: This food has way too much pepper on it!

NARRATOR: Now that you have your food, the waiter can begin to ask you if everything is all right.

WAITER: Is everything all right?

CUSTOMER: Yes. Thank you. Good-bye!

NARRATOR: Usually, when they ask if everything is all right, tell them the truth. Say . . .

CUSTOMER: Well, I had a problem with the peas. I received 143 peas. Of them, 36 were overcooked, 27 were undercooked, and 18 were not quite the same color as the others.

NARRATOR: Or tell them more than they really want to know.

CUSTOMER: No, everything is not all right. I'm going through a period of upheaval. I have a rogue polyp in my bowel, my wife ran off with a periodontist, and my son has been arrested for defecating in a mall.

NARRATOR: And always fill out the "How did we do?" card. It's very helpful to the owner.

CUSTOMER: *(writing on the comment card)* Everything was wonderful, except the waiter had some vomit on his shoes and a tiny snot on the end of his nose. It was small, but it was definitely a snot.

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AWARD HISTORY

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